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Dearest Léa,

Thank you for your letter. My heart broke to learn about Josef and André. For me, they had never died, and so they lived and died all over again as I grieved them the way you must have at the time, and am sure, still do. Can you tell me if André read my note before he was killed?

Katya and Eve sound like wonderful young women, and so accomplished. They obviously take after their mother. I do remember Josef's eyes—you once said they resembled the color of the pebbles at the bottom of the stream outside the barracks. Do you remember? And Katya, does she look like Nadiya? What have you told them about their parents? Do they know about me? About everything that happened?

Please can you write again and tell me about yourself? How did you end up in Paris—that is the return address on your letter. Tell me what you did. Maybe we don't get to choose who we save; some hand of fate decides on our behalf, and then our lives spin off in a different direction.

I accept your decision, though I still hold out hope that you might change your mind and come to Berlin. In any case, we can't lose touch again.

With all my love,

Rose

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Dearest Rose,

France was impossible for me after the war. I had trouble in Orléans—people called me a "collabo" because they knew I'd been in Germany. They were looking for women with any connection to Germany. I guess it was easy to blame us for what happened, as if our actions would have made a difference in the war.

When the baby started to show, I was accused of carrying a Nazi